Natalia Madrid

PhD Candidate in Economics, University of California San Diego
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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of California San Diego 2023–Present
Fields: Financial Economics and Environmental Economics.

Master of Arts in Economics, University of California San Diego 2025
Core courses: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics.

Master in Financial Management, Universidad de Concepción[1], Chile 2019
Thesis: Evaluation of the Impact of the 2008 Financial Crisis on Capital Structure of Companies in Latin America[2]. Advisor: Prof. Juan Gallegos.

B.Sc. in Industrial Engineering, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2018
Thesis: Ex-post evaluation of the R&D tax incentive law in Chile. Advisor: Prof. Cristian Mardones.

Research

Research Interests: Climate Finance, Banking, and Insurance

Work in Progress

Financial Frictions and Insurance Sector Resilience to Natural Disasters *(with Mariela Dal-Borgo)*

Mortgage Markets in the Aftermath of a Hurricane *(with Bartolo Villar-Hernández)*

Working Papers

Transmission of Climate Risk in Corporate Loans *(with Max Yang)*
[Available at SSRN]
Abstract: *Natural disasters are geographically concentrated, but corporate credit markets are integrated through national financial intermediaries, raising the question of whether local shocks propagate through lending networks. Using U.S. syndicated loan data around Hurricane Harvey (August 2017), we compare lenders with different pre-storm portfolio concentration in the damaged counties lending to the same unaffected borrower. Lenders one standard deviation more exposed to Harvey cut credit to unaffected borrowers by 4.8 percent, with no adjustment in spreads or maturities, even for borrowers more than 1,000 miles from the impact zone. Instead, the borrower's hurricane risk, measured by the historical frequency of hurricanes at its location, predicts the contraction: credit falls in hurricane-prone counties, exposed lenders move about two percentage points of their portfolios out of risky counties, and they are more likely to end relationships with hurricane-risky borrowers. The evidence is consistent with a highly visible disaster leading exposed lenders to move away from climate-risky borrowers throughout their portfolios, a reallocation of climate risk in quantities.*

Pre-doctoral Published Articles

Ex-post evaluation of the R&D tax incentive law in Chile *(with Cristian Mardones)*
[Available at DOI]
Abstract:*This study carries out an ex post evaluation of the Research and Development (R&D) Tax Incentive Law in Chile. The results obtained allow us to affirm that the use of the R&D Tax Incentive Law had some positive but very low effects on some components of expenditure for innovation. Also, the positive effect of the tax credits on the total expenditure for innovation identified with MDID disappears when only firms that know the R&D Tax Incentive Law are used as a control group. This work provides new evidence to evaluate innovation policies in Latin America, focusing on tax credits that have been much less studied than subsidy programs. Specifically, it is concluded that there is still a wide margin to improve and reformulate the R&D Tax Incentive Law in Chile.*

[1]The Universidad de Concepción ranks as the 3rd best university in Chile according to the Academic Ranking of World Universities (ARWU) and is ranked 11th in Latin America by the QS World University Rankings. I graduated with the highest distinction in both undergraduate and graduate studies, ranking in the top 5% of the class.

[2]Presented at the 10th INEKA (Innovation, Entrepreneurship and Knowledge Academy) Conference, Verona, Italy, 2019, by Prof. Juan Gallegos on behalf of both authors.

Conference, Workshops, and Summer Schools

Conference and Seminar Presentations

NBER Climate and Nature Finance Conference (poster), Norway 2026
Finance Brown Bag Seminar, Rady School of Management, UCSD 2026
Climate Conference, Climate Action Lab, UCSD 2026
Internal Macroeconomics Seminar, Economics Department, UCSD 2025
Internal Environmental Economics Seminar, Economics Department, UCSD 2025
Chilean Network of Innovation Researchers Conference, Chile 2021

Workshops and Summer Schools

CSWEP Mentoring Workshop (forthcoming), American Economic Association 2026
PhD Workshop on Climate Finance, National Bureau of Economic Research 2026
Summer School in Dynamic Structural Econometrics, University of Michigan 2026
Summer School in Environmental Economics, University of California Berkeley 2025

Research Experience

Summer Research Intern, Banco de México 2026
Summer Research Fellow at the General Directorate of Financial Stability, conducting research on financial stability topics. Supervisors: Calixto Lopez and Adrian Pardo.

Summer Graduate Research Fellow, University of California San Diego 2024
Independent summer research fellowship. Faculty advisor: Prof. Judson Boomhower.

Research Assistant, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2018
Supported research under Profs. Cristian Mardones and Pablo Catalán at the Center for the Study of Innovation Systems; co-authored a published paper on Chile's R&D tax incentive law; and contributed evidence-based insights on innovation policy for Chile's national economic development agency.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, University of California San Diego 2024–Present
- Graduate: Finance & Valuation in Corporate Finance (Prof. William Mullins) Winter 2025–26
- Graduate: Real Estate Finance (Prof. Carlos Avenancio-Leon) Spring 2026
- Undergraduate: Principles of Economics (Prof. Yinlin Dai, Prof. Judson Boomhower) Fall 2025–26
- Undergraduate: Econometrics (Prof. Graham Elliot, Prof. Yinlin Dai) Fall 2024–25

Lecturer, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2019–2020
Instructor for 120 students; designed course materials and supervised teaching assistants.
- Undergraduate: Accounting and Industrial Costs First Semester
- Undergraduate: Economic Engineering Second Semester

Relevant Professional Experience

Quality Management Specialist, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2020–2022
Redesigned quality management systems for training programs using Power BI; developed evaluation models for higher education quality practices (UCO 19101 Project).

Consulting Analyst, CameronPartners Innovation Consultants, Chile 2019–2020
Provided financial management advisory to 10+ SMEs; contributed to an acceleration program for 20 SMEs under CORFO's Innovation Fund for Competitiveness (FIC).

Honors, Scholarships, and Grants

Richard Libby Research Award ($10,000), Rady School of Management, UCSD 2026
Travel Grant ($800), Economics Department, UC San Diego 2026
Travel Grant ($500), Alfred P. Sloan Foundation, UC Berkeley 2025
Summer Research Scholarship ($3,500), University of California San Diego 2024
Regents Fellowship ($27,000), University of California San Diego 2023
Fulbright Doctorate Scholarship ($100,000), Fulbright Commission–ANID, Chile 2020
Outstanding Woman Engineer Award, Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2019
Merit Scholarship for a Master degree ($3,000), Universidad de Concepción, Chile 2016
Bicentennial Scholarship for Bachelor degree ($15,000), Ministry of Education, Chile 2012

Community Service and Leadership

Fulbright Board Member, San Diego Fulbright Chapter 2026–Present
Summer Reading Group Coordinator, Climate Change Economics, UCSD 2025
Educational Mentor, Powerful Women Program, WoomUp, Chile 2020
Student Council Member, Industrial Engineering Student Association, UDEC 2016

Academic and Professional Memberships

American Finance Association · Association of Environmental and Resource Economists
Fulbright Association · Econometric Society · Southern Economic Association

Languages, Skills and Citizenship

Languages: English (C1), Spanish (native)
Computing: Python, STATA, C++, MySQL, LaTeX, HTML/CSS, Microsoft Office
Citizenship: Chile

References

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